

Answer Key

Grade 2 Intermediate Passages

1. The Extra Cheese Stick

1. What is Jay's problem at lunch?
B. His lunch bag is not in his backpack.
2. How does Elena help Jay?
B. She shares her sandwich and apple slices.
3. How does Jay thank Elena?
A. He brings her an extra cheese stick the next day.

2. Pepper on the Shelf

1. What is Nina's problem?
B. Pepper got out of the cage.
2. Where does Nina find Pepper?
B. In a box of paper scraps on the art shelf
3. What keeps Pepper from getting out again?
C. They add a second clip, and Nina checks the latch.

3. The Popped Ball

1. What goes wrong in the gym?
C. Leo pops the class ball on a chair leg.
2. What does Leo do after the ball pops?
A. He tells Coach Ramirez the truth.
3. How is the problem finally solved?
B. Leo tapes the hole, and Coach brings a new ball.

4. The Paper Crown

1. What is missing before the play?
C. The paper crown for the king
2. What do Omar and Lila make?
C. A new crown from paper, tape, and drawn jewels
3. How does the story end?
A. Omar wears the new crown and remembers his lines.

5. Ants at the Picnic

1. What is the problem at the picnic?
D. Ants crawl onto the blanket toward the food.
2. Why does waving his hands not work?
C. More ants keep coming onto the blanket.
3. What solves the problem?
B. They move the food in closed tubs to a table.

6. The Slipped Chain

1. What happens to Rosa's bike?
B. The chain slips off and the bike will not move.
2. What does Rosa do on her first try?
D. She misses when she tries to set the chain.
3. How does the story end?
B. The chain stays on, and Rosa rides home.

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7. The Cloudy Tank

1. Why is the tank cloudy?
D. The fish got too much food.
2. What does Ben do with the extra flakes?
B. He scoops them out with a net.
3. How do they stop a second feeding?
B. Ben tapes a feeding chart on the tank.

8. Glasses in the Pocket

1. What is Priya's problem?
D. She cannot find her glasses before a test.
2. Where are the glasses?
D. In the front pocket of her hoodie
3. What does Priya do so she will not lose them again?
C. She clips the case to her backpack.

9. The Storm Cloud

1. What happens to Andre's painting?
D. His sleeve smears gray paint across the sun.
2. What does Ms. Brooks tell Andre to do?
B. Wait until the paper dries before he decides.
3. How does Andre solve the problem?
D. He turns the smear into a storm cloud.

10. The Missing Slip

1. What is Sofia missing?
A. The permission slip for the museum trip
2. Where do they find the slip?
B. Under a pad of paper in the kitchen drawer
3. How does Sofia get on the trip list?
D. Dad signs the slip, and she turns it in.

11. A Spot in Line

1. What is the problem at recess?
B. Noah is new and sitting alone.
2. How does Camila help Noah learn the game?
C. She explains kick, run, and tag the base.
3. How does the story end?
C. Noah plays, and Camila saves him a spot the next day.

12. Two Missing Boxes

1. What problem does Hector have?
C. He is two cookie boxes short of his count.
2. Where are the missing boxes?
A. Behind the counter, hidden by a poster board
3. What does Hector do after the count matches?
A. He sells the cookies and moves the extra boxes forward.

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13. Vacuum Day

1. What is the problem on Saturday?
C. Bean hides and shakes when the vacuum is on.
2. What does Amina do before she turns the vacuum on again?
A. She lets Bean sniff the silent machine.
3. How does the story end?
D. Bean watches from his bed and does not hide.

14. The Ripped Poster

1. What is wrong with the poster?
B. A rip goes through the sentence about clouds.
2. What does Lila do instead of hiding the rip?
B. She shows her partners and they tape the back.
3. How does the presentation go?
D. The poster stays together and the class can read it.

15. Cups for the Party

1. What happens to Malik's cup tower?
D. His elbow bumps it and the cups roll off.
2. What do they do with the crushed cups?
D. They set them aside for the recycling bin.
3. Why does the new stack stay up?
A. It is shorter and has a wide bottom.

16. The Borrowed Recorder

1. What is Noor's problem?
A. She left her recorder at home.
2. How does Noor play with the group?
D. She borrows a spare recorder from Mr. Ellis.
3. What does Noor do so it will not happen again?
B. She clips her recorder to her folder.

17. Shade for the Plant

1. What happens to Owen's bean plant?
B. It wilts after he leaves it in a hot car.
2. What do Owen and Dad do first?
C. They move the pot into the shade.
3. How does Owen try to keep the problem from happening again?
C. He writes a warning note on the pot.

18. The Missing Card

1. What is missing from the math pattern?
D. The red triangle card
2. Where does Jade look before she opens the book?
B. On the rug, in the supply bin, and in her folder
3. How does the group finish the pattern?
A. Jade cuts a red paper triangle to match the book.

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19. A Wet Spelling List

1. What happens to Luis's spelling list?
A. Water from his bottle blurs the words.
2. What does Luis do when he sees the wet page?
C. He tells Ms. Ortiz instead of hiding it.
3. How is Luis ready for the test?
B. He copies a dry list and studies the words.

20. The Broken Lace

1. What is Mina's problem at recess?
B. Her shoelace snaps and the shoe flaps.
2. Where does Mina get a new lace?
D. From the lost-and-found bin in the office
3. How does the story end?
A. The new lace stays tied and Mina joins the game.

21. The Upside-Down Card

1. What is Theo's problem?
C. His locker will not open before class.
2. Why do the first numbers fail?
A. He is reading the card upside down.
3. How does Theo keep from mixing up the numbers again?
D. He tapes the card right-side up in his folder.

22. The Tipped Cup

1. What goes wrong with the class butterfly?
A. The cup tips and the butterfly lands on the floor.
2. How does Hana pick the butterfly up?
D. She slides a paper under it without pinching the wings.
3. What do they do so the cup will not tip again?
D. They move it away from the edge and post a sign.

23. The Leaky Volcano

1. What is wrong with Cole's volcano?
C. Foam leaks from a crack before the fair.
2. What does Cole do to the seam?
A. He tapes it and spreads glue over the tape.
3. How does Cole know the fix worked?
A. A test in the sink sends foam out the top.

24. The Book at Ivy's

1. Where is Ivy's library book?
A. At Nico's house, under a couch cushion
2. How do Ivy and Nico plan to meet?
C. Nico will bring the book to the bus stop.
3. How does the story end?
C. Ivy gets the book and returns it on time.

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25. The Knotted Yo-Yo

1. What is wrong with Sam's yo-yo?
B. The string is knotted and will not wind.
2. What does Sam almost do?
D. Cut the string with dull scissors
3. How does he undo the knot?
D. He loosens it with a pencil, one loop at a time.

26. Ball on the Roof

1. What is Nora's problem?
C. The kickball is stuck on the school roof.
2. Why does Nora stop a student from climbing?
A. The roof is not a safe way to get the ball.
3. How do they get the ball down?
A. Mr. Shah frees it with a long pole, and Nora catches it.

27. The Milk Count

1. What is Amir's problem?
A. His milk count is two short of the class list.
2. How do Amir and Priya count the second time?
C. They make stacks of five and count the extras.
3. Why was the first count wrong?
B. Two cartons were stuck together and he skipped them.

28. The Mask Strap

1. What is wrong with Lucy's mask?
A. A strap tears and the mask slides down.
2. Why does Lucy not use glue?
A. It would not dry before the parade.
3. How is the mask fixed?
C. They staple on a new paper strap.

29. The Office Arrow

1. What is wrong with the school map?
A. The office arrow points to the gym.
2. How does the group find the real office?
A. They walk the hall and count the doors.
3. How do they know the new arrow works?
C. A partner follows it and reaches the office.

30. The Melting Ice

1. What goes wrong with Mei's ice test?
D. The ice melts too fast in the sunny window.
2. What does Mei change the second time?
B. She moves the cup from the sun to the shade.
3. What does Mei learn from the second test?
B. Shade makes the ice melt more slowly.